GLOSSARY

CHAPTER 13

GLOSSARY

[A] **ACCESS FOR ALL** is a workforce development program whose purpose is to bring innovation to "pre-apprenticeship" programming.

AMERICAN LAND TITLE ASSOCIATION is the national trade association of title insurance companies.

ARCHITECTURAL SALVAGE WAREHOUSE OF DETROIT is a nonprofit organization focused on keeping building materials out of landfills through architectural salvage with a mission of promoting: environmental sustainability, job creation and training, and preservation and conservation.

[B] **BLEXTING** is the mobile survey application that was used for the Motor City Mapping Survey. Blexting is a combination of "Blight" and "Texting".

THE BLIGHT REMOVAL TASK FORCE (TASK FORCE) is a public-private partnership committed to developing a straightforward and detailed implementation plan to remove every blighted, vacant or abandoned residential structure, commercial structure, and public building, and clear every neglected vacant lot in the City of Detroit as quickly as possible. The Task Force was established by Federal, State of Michigan and City of Detroit leaders.

BRIGHTMOOR ALLIANCE is a coalition of organizations dedicated to serving northwest Detroit's Brightmoor community. The Alliance was established in 2000 in response to conditions in the community, including poor housing, a high crime rate, and a staggering amount of vacant land. The Alliance supports community organizations engaged in combating deterioration of the Brightmoor community, providing job training, educational and housing opportunities for economically disadvantaged youth and residents of the community.

[C] The **COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT BLOCK GRANT PROGRAM (CDBG)** is a program that provides communities with resources to address a wide range of unique community development needs and is funded through the U.S. Housing and Urban Development Department.

A **COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION (CDC)** is a nonprofit, community based organization focused on revitalizing the area in which they are located by providing programs, offering services, and engaging in other activities that promote and support community development.

A **COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT FINANCIAL INSTITUTION (CDFI)** is a financial institution which provides credit and financial services to underserved markets. CDFIs are certified by the Community Development Financial Institutions Fund at the U.S. Department of the Treasury, which provides funds to CDFIs through a variety of programs.

CENTER FOR COMMUNITY PROGRESS is a nonprofit organization focused on ensuring that communities have the vision, knowledge and systems available to transform blighted, vacant and other problem properties into assets.

CHANCE FOR LIFE is a nonprofit organization created to promote community safety by offering a progressive transformational workforce development program that prepares previously incarcerated individuals for a successful transition into their communities.

The **CITY OF DETROIT ASSESSOR'S OFFICE** is responsible for appraising real estate and assessing a property tax on properties located in the City of Detroit.

The **CITY OF DETROIT BUILDINGS, SAFETY ENVIRONMENT, AND ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT (BSEED)** administers and enforces construction and environmental codes and regulates the construction and alteration of buildings in the city. It is also responsible for inspecting dangerous buildings and if necessary, demolishing them.

The **CITY OF DETROIT CLERK'S OFFICE** is responsible for administering oaths, taking affidavits, serving as Clerk to City Council, Chief Elections Officer of the City, and is custodian of the Corporate Seal. The City Clerk maintains the record of the City Council and City Code of Ordinances and exercises other powers and duties as provided by law.

The **CITY OF DETROIT DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE HEARINGS (DAH)** is a quasi-judicial body that adjudicates blight violations in Detroit.

The **CITY OF DETROIT DEPARTMENT OF NEIGHBORHOODS (DON)** is a new Cabinet department created by Mayor Duggan to bring together many of the disparate agencies and offices of the city that directly affect Detroit's neighborhoods. It also serves to coordinate the services and activities of other agencies that touch on the neighborhoods, by convening them regularly to coordinate their services on a particular topic.

The **CITY OF DETROIT DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS (DPW)** is responsible for providing essential environmental and infrastructure services, thereby ensuring a safe and clean environment for customers in a cost-efficient manner.

The **CITY OF DETROIT DEPARTMENT OF RECREATION** is responsible for the quality of service in the management of parks and leisure facilities.

The **CITY OF DETROIT LAW DEPARTMENT** is responsible for delivering legal counseling and representation to the executive and legislative branches of city government as mandated by the City Charter, including provision of advice and opinions; preparation of legislative ordinances and resolutions; prosecution and defense of all legal actions for an against the City; prosecution of Charter and City ordinance violations; and preparation and/or approval of all City contracts, bonds and other written instruments.

The **CITY OF DETROIT PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT** is a part of the Jobs and Economy Team and is tasked with planning and with real estate and housing development and services within the city.

CITY ORDINANCE 290-H is a City of Detroit ordinance which gives city building inspectors flexibility to determine whether a property is dangerous. It applies to vacant, open and dangerous structures, but does not include inhabited homes.

The **COMMUNITY REINVESTMENT ACT (CRA)** is a U.S. federal law which requires that commercial banks and savings associations lend and invest in the communities in which they are located, including low and moderate income neighborhoods.

The **COMMUNITY RESTORATION CORPORATION (CRC)** is a national nonprofit organization created by the Housing Partnership Network and National Community Stabilization Trust to address the very low value of distressed assets in neighborhoods of greatest need prior to a foreclosure sale and create flexible options for the optimal future disposition of these properties.

[D] DATA DRIVEN DETROIT (D3) is an affiliate of the Michigan Nonprofit Association that provides accessible, high-quality information and analysis to drive informed decisions.

DEEP DIVE DETROIT is an organization which fosters important conversations on uncomfortable topics between disparate groups.

The **DETROIT BUILDING AUTHORITY (DBA)** is the agency responsible for construction and maintenance of city-owned buildings with newly expanded responsibilities under Mayor Duggan including acting as the manager of demolition contracting for all city departments, and on a contract basis for the Detroit Land Bank Authority.

The **DETROIT DATA COLLABORATIVE** is a public-private partnership between the Detroit Office of Foreclosure Prevention and Response, Community Legal Resources and Data Driven Detroit created to mine data related to Detroit residential real estate.

The **DETROIT ECONOMIC GROWTH CORPORATION (DEGC)** is a nonprofit quasi-governmental agency responsible for economic development in Detroit. It is run by an independent Board of Directors and is not subject to the civil service, procurement or other regulations that apply to the city or the state. The DEGC provides various financing tools and other programs to accomplish its mission.

The **DETROIT EMERGENCY MANAGER**, Kevyn Orr, was appointed by the Governor of Michigan and the Michigan Department of Treasury and derives his authority under Public Act 436 of 2012, the Local Financial Stability and Choice Act. The role is to remedy the financial distress of the City of Detroit by requiring, using available resources, prudent fiscal management and an efficient provision of municipal services by exercising the necessary authority conferred to take appropriate action on behalf of the city and its residents.

The **DETROIT EMPLOYMENT SOLUTIONS CORPORATION (DESC)** provides employers with access to Detroit jobseekers with a wide range of job-related services (including screening and training) through partnerships with community-based and faith-based organizations.

DETROIT FUTURE CITY (DFC) is the entity which released the Detroit Future City Strategic Framework in 2013, which is a detailed long term guide for decision-making on land use by all of the stakeholders in the City. The Strategic Framework was created through a 24-month long public process that drew upon interactions among Detroit residents and civic leaders from both the nonprofit and for-profit sectors.

The **DETROIT LAND BANK AUTHORITY** is a nonprofit quasi-governmental agency that was created by contract between the State of Michigan and the City of Detroit. It is run by an independent Board of Directors and is not subject to the civil service, procurement or other regulations that apply to the city or the state. In addition, under Michigan's Land Bank Fast Track Act, it has special powers to assemble and dispose of properties in the city in a coordinated way, as required to stabilize neighborhoods and promote growth.

The **DETROIT MASTER PLAN OF POLICIES** sets forth a citywide comprehensive long-range strategy. The document is intended to be both long range and visionary and provide guidance for actions to be taken in the next ten years. The City of Detroit's Charter mandates that the mayor shall propose and the city council shall approve, a master plan of policies for the social, economic and physical development and conservation of the city.

DETROIT OFFICE OF FORECLOSURE PREVENTION AND RESPONSE is an independent public-private agency that serves as a centralized clearinghouse to share tools, resources, and recommendations to leverage and enhance the work of partners throughout the City of Detroit to reduce the effects of the foreclosure crisis on families and neighborhoods.

DETROIT ORDINANCE 290-H is the city ordinance which governs the demolition and deconstruction of dangerous and abandoned structures in the City of Detroit.

The **DETROIT REGISTERED APPRENTICE PROGRAM (D-RAP)** is a training program through the Detroit Employment Solutions Corporation (DESC) designed to assist Detroit's economic recovery enabling workers to acquire technical skills.

The **DETROIT RESIDENTIAL PARCEL SURVEY** was a survey conducted by the Data Collaborative in 2009 which surveyed 343,000 residential parcels in Detroit. The survey contained information on building type, condition, vacancy, fire damage, and open and dangerous conditions. The result was a baseline for neighborhood organizations, foundations and city departments to use in planning.

The **DETROIT TRAINING CENTER (DTC)** specializes in offering customized vocational programs of study, tailored to meet the needs of individuals, contractors, governmental, and non-profit organizations.

The **DETROIT WATER AND SEWERAGE DEPARTMENT (DWSD)** is a public utility and is one of the largest water and sewer utilities in the United States.

DISTRICT MANAGERS AND ASSISTANT DISTRICT MANAGERS have been appointed for each of the City Council Districts. These new positions report to the Department of Neighborhoods and are responsible for establishing and maintaining constant communication between the city and the community groups, block clubs, neighborhood organizations and faith-based groups in their districts, as well as with their Council member and staff. They must attend the regularly scheduled meetings of these organizations, and be prepared to brief them on the activities of any city agency or department in their neighborhood, to take questions and solicit comments on those activities and city policies, and to convey their district's views back to the city and its agencies.

DTE ENERGY is a public utility which provides electric services to the Detroit's residents, and is involved in the development and management of a diversified set of energy related businesses and services nationwide.

[E]

ECOWORKS is a Detroit-based nonprofit organization which provides energy efficiency, green building and sustainability services to residents, businesses, local governments and professionals.

[F] **FANNIE MAE** is the common name given to the Federal National Mortgage Association (FNMA). Fannie Mae is the leading secondary market purchaser of residential mortgage loans in the U.S. and is a major driver of the nation's housing finance system.

FEDERAL EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT AGENCY (FEMA) is an agency of the U.S. Department of Homeland Security tasked with coordinating responses to disasters that happen within the United States and overwhelms local and state resources. FEMA supports citizens and first responders to work together to build, sustain, and improve capacity to prepare for, protect against, respond to, recover from, and mitigate all hazards.

FIRE INSURANCE WITHHOLDING PROGRAM (ESCROW FUND) provides municipalities some financial protection against the cost of clearing up a damaged structure following a fire loss. The Fund requires insurance companies to give municipalities twenty-five percent of the insurance proceeds for each burned-out house within their boundaries, up to $6,000 if an owner fails to raze their house.

FOCUS: HOPE is a nonprofit organization based in Detroit focused primarily on food distribution to low-income individuals and a variety of workforce development programs.

[H] The **HARDEST HIT FUNDS PROGRAM** is a national program to develop locally-tailored programs to assist struggling homeowners in their communities. The programs are being funded through a $7.6 billion fund established by the United States Department of Treasury. The funds are geared toward 18 states which were hit particularly hard by the mortgage crisis, including Michigan. The Michigan program is administered by the Michigan State Housing Development Authority.

The **HOUSING PARTNERSHIP NETWORK** is a peer network and business cooperative of affordable housing nonprofits in the United States which aims to build affordable homes and vibrant communities for low- and moderate-income people through partnerships with the member organizations, the business sector, government, and philanthropic institutions.

[J] The **JOBS AND ECONOMY TEAM** was created by Mayor Duggan to gather together all of the agencies and departments in the city with the responsibility of creating jobs and spurring economic development.

[L] **LIS PENDENS** is a written notice that a lawsuit has been filed concerning real estate, involving either the title to the property or a claimed ownership interest in it. The notice is usually filed in the county land records office, which alerts a potential purchaser or lender that the property's title is in question, which makes the property less attractive to a buyer or lender.

LOVELAND TECHNOLOGIES is a Detroit based technology company which develops interactive property mapping systems to gather and present public information about properties in clear, actionable ways.

[M] The **MAXIMIZING COMMUNITY IMPACT TOOL (MCI)** is a software tool designed to assist planners in prioritizing geographic areas for blight removal. The tool utilizes the Motor City Mapping data and additional data to combine information about property ownership and condition, neighborhood occupancy, housing market activity and foreclosures.

MCL 600.2819 is the State of Michigan statute which provides that a judgment lien cannot be foreclosed upon. This statute codifies PA-192.

The **MICHIGAN DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENTAL QUALITY (MDEQ)** is the state government office responsible for managing and regulating Michigan's air, land and water resources.

MICHIGAN COMMUNITY RESOURCES is a non-profit organization which provides comprehensive support for low-income communities in Michigan, including legal, policy, education, outreach, planning and technical skills.

The **MICHIGAN HISTORIC PRESERVATION NETWORK** is a statewide nonprofit organization that advocates for the recognition and preservation of cultural and architectural heritage.

MICHIGAN NONPROFIT ASSOCIATION is a statewide membership organization dedicated to serving the nonprofit sector through civic engagement, capacity-building, data and technology, training and advocacy.

MICHIGAN OCCUPATIONAL SAFETY AND HEALTH ADMINISTRATION (MIOSHA) is Michigan's regulatory body responsible for assuring safe and healthful working conditions for working men and women in Michigan.

The **MICHIGAN PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION (MPSC)** is a regulatory agency responsible for overseeing public utilities in Michigan

MICHIGAN STATE HOUSING DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY (MSHDA) provides financial and technical assistance through public and private partnerships with the goal of creating and preserving safe and decent affordable housing.

MOTOR CITY MAPPING is a comprehensive city-wide survey that gathered detailed information on the condition of every one of the City of Detroit's parcels. The data was collected via a citywide physical survey, where the surveyors visited and photographed the front of each property and answered a series of questions related to the properties' physical condition based on what they could observe.

[N] The **NATIONAL COMMUNITY STABILIZATION TRUST (NCST)** is a national nonprofit organization that works with the nation's largest financial institutions and local housing providers to give the housing providers ways to acquire foreclosed and abandoned properties from the financial institutions. The Trust was formed in 2008 to assist local communities in weathering the foreclosure crisis and to stabilize distressed neighborhoods.

NATIONAL EMISSION STANDARDS FOR HAZARDOUS AIR POLLUTANTS (NESHAP) are stationary source standards for hazardous air pollutants. Hazardous air pollutants (HAPs) are those pollutants that are known or suspected to cause cancer or other serious health effects, such as reproductive effects or birth defects, or adverse environmental effects.

NEXTENERGY is a nonprofit organization focused on driving advanced energy investment and job creation in Michigan. NextEnergy focuses on advanced energy technology demonstration and commercialization, and utilizes analytical tools to assess market trends, technology innovation, policy and investment strategies.

NEIGHBORHOOD STABILIZATION PROGRAM (NSP) grants were established for the purpose of stabilizing communities that have suffered from foreclosures and abandonment through the purchase and redevelopment of foreclosed and abandoned homes and residential properties.

The **NUISANCE ABATEMENT PROGRAM** of the Detroit Land Bank files common law nuisance lawsuits against private owners in the city who have abandoned their properties with the goal of abating the nuisance by taking the title of the property.

[O] The **OFFICE OF THE MAYOR** of the City of Detroit is the chief executive of the city and, as provided by the Charter, has control and is accountable for the executive branch of city government. The Mayor is elected by and is accountable to the citizens of the city. While the City of Detroit is under the supervision of an Emergency Manager, the Mayor's powers and responsibilities are limited to operations only and not financial or public safety.

[P] **PA-192** is a State of Michigan statute that authorizes local government to foreclose on property owned by a person who has failed to pay fines imposed for blight violations.

The **PLAN FOR THE ADJUSTMENT OF DEBTS OF THE CITY OF DETROIT ("PLAN OF ADJUSTMENT")** is the plan which provides for the treatment of the various classes of creditors' claims against the city under the bankruptcy proceedings. The city proposes the plan, and the bankruptcy court then must confirm the plan in accordance with the bankruptcy laws. The court's confirmation leads to the city's emergence from bankruptcy.

PRESERVATION DETROIT is a Detroit-based nonprofit organization dedicated to preserving, promoting and protecting Detroit's cultural and architectural heritage through education, advocacy, research and awareness campaigns.

[R] **RECLAIM DETROIT** was founded in 2011 as a part of EcoWorks and centers around deconstruction efforts to divert as much material from Detroit's structures from landfills as possible.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) is a solicitation made by an entity looking to procure a product or service, asking potential suppliers to submit bids or proposals. The RFP process brings structure to the procurement decision.

ROCK VENTURES FAMILY OF COMPANIES is portfolio of over 100 businesses located in 15 different states ranging from sports and entertainment businesses (like the National Basketball Association's Cleveland Cavaliers and Detroit's Greektown Casino) to Quicken Loans, the largest online mortgage lender in the country, to innovative Internet startups and cutting edge digital marketing companies. Dan Gilbert is the majority owner of most of the Rock Ventures businesses.

[S] **SB 0295** is a proposed amendment to the State of Michigan's General Property Tax Act which would preclude a bidder from bidding on foreclosed property if the bidder had unpaid fines for violating local blight or nuisance ordinances. It also requires bidders to pre-register two weeks before a sale, and certify that they didn't own foreclosed property in the previous three tax years.

SERVICE EMPLOYMENT REDEVELOPMENT (SER) METRO-DETROIT is a training program in Detroit that focuses on providing skills training and placement of consumers into unsubsidized employment in the private sector and in providing employers with a diverse, qualified workforce.

SOUTHEAST MICHIGAN COUNCIL OF GOVERNMENTS (SEMCOG) is a regional planning partnership in southeast. Michigan established in 1968 whose membership is comprised of local government entities.

The **SPRINGWELLS PROJECT** was a Detroit Future City sponsored partial deconstruction pilot project in Southwest Detroit, Springwells Village neighborhood which included 10 structures. The purpose was to evaluate the benefits of deconstruction generally on damaged structures, and specifically on deconstruction as it relates to Detroit's unique inventory of vacant, open, and dangerous buildings and to identify obstacles, benchmark productivity and establish metrics, while also understanding the implications of ambient lead dispersals associated with these activities.

STAHELIN BLOCK ASSOCIATION is a neighbor based block club located on Detroit's northwest side of town generally bounded by the Southfield Freeway and Joy Road.

STEP FORWARD MICHIGAN is a series of forgivable loan programs administered by the Michigan Homeowner Assistance Nonprofit Housing Corporation acting through the Michigan State Housing Development Authority designed to help Michigan homeowners who have had a financial hardship. The programs are funded through the Hardest Hit Fund.

The **STRATEGIC ASSESSMENT TRIAGE TOOL (SATT)** is a software tool designed to objectively evaluate and analyze structural data (e.g. environmental data, degree of damage), along with the information obtained through Motor City Mapping to assist planners in determining specifically what type of action (if any) needs to occur for each property.

[T] **THE BLIGHT AUTHORITY** is a privately owned, nonprofit company formed in 2013 to manage the clearance of blight. The Blight Authority focuses on removal of blighted structures, as well as debris and overgrown brush.

THE KRESGE FOUNDATION is a private, national philanthropic foundation that works to expand opportunities in America's cities through grant making and investing in arts and culture, education, environment, health, human services, community development and place-based efforts in Detroit.

THE SKILLMAN FOUNDATION is a private philanthropic foundation which works to improve the lives of Detroit's children. The Foundation focuses on education, safety, social innovation, neighborhoods, community leadership and youth development.

[U] The **U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HOUSING AND URBAN DEVELOPMENT (HUD)** is a cabinet level department of the federal government focusing on creating strong, sustainable, inclusive communities and quality affordable homes for all.

The **U.S. DEPARTMENT OF TREASURY** is a cabinet level department of the federal government which promotes economic growth through policies to support job creation, investment and economic stability. The Department of Treasury also oversees the production of coins and currency, the disbursement of payments to the public, tax collection and management of the funds to run the federal government.

The **U.S. ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY** is an agency of the federal government with a purpose of protecting human health and the environment through the creation and regulation of laws.

UNITED STREETS NETWORKING AND PLANNING BUILDING A COMMUNITY (U-SNAP-BAC) is a consortium of community and business organizations, working together to empower residents to impact the future of Detroit's Eastside. U-SNAP-BAC focuses on promoting economic growth and neighborhood improvement through coalition building, resource development, joint planning and programming.

The **UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN GINSBERG CENTER** is a service-learning center that offers a variety of programs and services for University of Michigan students and faculty to learn through community service and civic participation.

[V] The **VACANT PROPERTY COALITION OF DETROIT** is facilitated by the Michigan Community Resources (MCR) to coordinate strategies to address the impact of vacant properties in Detroit.

[W] The **OFFICE OF THE WAYNE COUNTY TREASURER** is responsible to the people of Wayne County for the administration of the Property Tax Collection, and for receipt, custody, investment and disbursement of all County funds.

WAYNE STATE UNIVERSITY CENTER FOR URBAN STUDIES is a program at Wayne State University, located in Detroit, which focuses on providing innovative responses to urban challenges. The Center conducts and disseminates research, develops policies and programs, and provides training, capacity-building, and technical assistance.



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CHAPTER 14

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